

Joseph Prince

CTO · STAFF-LEVEL BACKEND ENGINEER

Remote (US) · Denver, Colorado (MT) · thejosephprince.com · linkedin.com/in/thejprince · github.com/dedrozs

SUMMARY

Engineering leader who never stopped shipping. Primary author of four production backend systems - regulated compliance workflows, payment and screening pipelines, multi-tenant realtime services - built and maintained over four years at the same company while progressing from a non-technical marketing role to CTO, fully remote the entire time. A high-ownership IC first - system design, data modeling, and API architecture from schema to production - while managing a developer, directing an outsourced vendor team, and still shipping production code every week.

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer · Sports Thread

Jan 2026 – Present

- Own architecture, scalability and security across the platform, and set technical direction for all engineering work.
- Provide engineering oversight of the outsourced vendor team maintaining the core platform: audited their codebase and produced a cost-engineering assessment that sized each remediation and reclassified a misdiagnosed infrastructure issue.
- Authored a technical proposal analysing four independent authentication systems across roughly 350 routes; accepted and implemented.
- Remain the highest-output individual contributor on the team - authored commit volume has increased every year since 2022, with 2026 the highest to date.

VP of Software Development · Sports Thread

Nov 2023 – Jan 2026

- Architected and wrote the Django platform fronting partner integrations and coach credentialing end to end - registration, waivers, payment, third-party screening and roster provisioning (93% of 571 commits).
- Built the multi-tenant recruiting CRM backend serving 600+ tenant organizations: REST and WebSocket from a single ASGI deployment, JWT with refresh-token rotation and blacklisting, async import pipeline with progress streaming (88% of 156 commits, 340 tests).
- Hired and manage the frontend developer building against these APIs.

Director of Software Engineering · Sports Thread

Jun 2022 – Nov 2023

- Built the age-verification and compliance platform that remains the operational backbone of event certification - 26 Django apps, 413 tests, 90% of 433 commits sustained over 3.5 years.
- Reimplemented business rules from a vendor-maintained service written in another language and held them to behavioural parity, down to byte-identical JSON serialisation so records stayed interoperable across both systems.
- Established the Clean Architecture and domain-driven design standard that every subsequent backend was built on.

Marketing Manager · Sports Thread

Jan 2022 – Jun 2022

- Hired into a non-technical role and began writing production code against real company problems within weeks; the engineering title followed six months later.

SELECTED PRODUCTION SYSTEMS

Closed source. Client, vendor and partner identities withheld; architecture and personal contribution described in full.

Age Verification & Compliance Platform

Sole architect · 90% of 433 commits · 3.5 years

Compliance engine evaluating every athlete registration in an event against a status-priority algorithm to surface exactly what blocks certification. Duplicate-registration detection across name/DOB collisions, cross-roster conflict flagging, and document-request workflows across three verification-failure modes.

DJANGO · MYSQL · CLEAN ARCHITECTURE · DDD · GCP

Coach Credentialing & Background Check Platform

Architect · 93% of 571 commits · active

Onboarding end to end across multiple external partner integrations. Screening is performed by a regulated third-party agency; built the boundary around it - duplicate adverse actions refused, local state and an immutable audit record committed in a single transaction, agency failures surfaced as gateway errors rather than masked.

DJANGO · DRF · MYSQL · PAYMENTS · STATE MACHINES

Multi-Tenant Recruiting CRM (backend)

Backend architect · 88% of 156 commits · 600+ tenants

Collaborative boards with realtime updates streamed to every connected teammate. Tenant isolation enforced at the query layer: every endpoint scopes through the ownership chain rather than trusting a request parameter, and every viewset defaults to an empty queryset so a missing scope leaks nothing.

DJANGO · CHANNELS · REDIS · ASGI · WEBSOCKETS

Competitive Rating & Entity Resolution

Sole implementer · methodology developed with the business

Rating system for teams that never share a full schedule, propagating strength of schedule transitively through the opponent graph. Built the entity resolution layer that stops one real-world club counting as several - a shared-staff gate prevents false merges, and tiered confidence routes ambiguous pairs to human review rather than guessing.

PYTHON · DJANGO · MYSQL · GRAPH TRAVERSAL

SKILLS

BACKEND	Python · Django · Django REST Framework · Clean Architecture · DDD · REST APIs · System design · Data modeling
FRONTEND	React · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS · Vite
DATA & MESSAGING	MySQL · Redis · WebSockets (ASGI) · Background task queues · pgvector
CLOUD & DELIVERY	Google Cloud · AWS · Docker · CI/CD · GitHub Actions
AI INTEGRATION	Anthropic API · OpenAI API · Embeddings & retrieval
LEADERSHIP	Architecture review · Vendor oversight · Mentoring · Technical writing

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.S. Computer Science — Colorado Technical University (2026)
Certified Scrum Master, Product Owner & Developer (CSM, CSPO, CSD) — Scrum Alliance
Digital Marketing Immersion — Thinkful